



United States
Attorney's Office
District of Connecticut



Waterbury Woman Pleads Guilty, Admits Multiple Fraud Schemes

Friday, June 13, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, District of
Connecticut

David X. Sullivan, United States Attorney for the District of Connecticut, announced that MARLENIN VITO, 46, of Waterbury, pleaded guilty today in New Haven federal court to an offense stemming from multiple fraud schemes.

According to court documents and statements made in court, Vito was employed as Medicaid Coordinator at an assisted living facility ("Company A") located in Stamford. Vito's responsibilities included assisting the residents in applying for nursing home level Medicaid reimbursements, monitoring the residents' patient trust accounts, and ensuring compliance with Medicaid regulations. She was also responsible for keeping journal entries for the residents' trust accounts and to credit their accounts when funds were received, and for debiting patient accounts when payments were made on behalf of the residents or when cash was given to residents for incidental expenses.

Between approximately December 2019 and May 2021, Vito defrauded Company A and its residents by generating checks from Company A's system, forging a fellow employee's signature on the checks, negotiating the fraudulent checks purportedly to give the cash proceeds to certain residents, and keeping the cash for her own use. Vito then made false entries into Company A's accounting ledger by debiting the fraudulently obtained cash from the residents' respective trust accounts. Many of the residents were not healthy enough or mentally capable of tracking their own expenses or monitoring the balances of their own trust accounts.

In certain instances, Vito cancelled residents' supplemental health insurance coverage, but continued to deduct funds from the trust accounts and took the funds for herself. Also, when certain residents' trust accounts were credited with Economic Impact Payments ("COVID-19 stimulus payments"), Vito took the funds for herself and then debited the residents' accounts at a rate of approximately \$60 a day until the stimulus funds were depleted.

During the scheme, Vito fraudulently negotiated approximately 500 checks, stealing approximately \$310,820. When she was confronted by family members of certain residents, Vito created and provided to those family members false account statements that misrepresented the balances in the residents' trust accounts.

After she was terminated by Company A, Vito obtained employment as a bookkeeper and scheduler at an alarm company ("Company B") located in White Plains, New York. Vito stole from the company by making false representations about overtime for herself and her daughter, and by using company funds to order more than \$10,000 worth of products to be delivered to her Waterbury residence. Company B was defrauded of approximately \$23,558 through these schemes.

After she was terminated by Company B, Vito was employed as a bookkeeper at a law firm in Hartford ("Company C"). Vito took fraudulently generated checks drawn on Company C's bank account and issued as "Pay to the Order of 'Petty Cash, '" forged the signature of an authorized employee on the checks, cashed the checks, and kept the funds for herself. She then recorded the fraudulently negotiated checks in Company C's books and records as "Petty Cash." Vito stole approximately \$27,179 from Company C.

Vito pleaded guilty to one count of wire fraud, an offense that carries a maximum term of imprisonment of 20 years. She is scheduled to be sentenced on September 10.

Vito is released on a \$25,000 bond pending sentencing.

This investigation is being conducted by the Federal Bureau of Investigation, with the assistance of the Stamford Police Department, Hartford Police Department, Ridgefield Police Department, and the Putnam County (N.Y.) Sheriff's Office. The case is being prosecuted by Assistant U.S. Attorneys Michael S. McGarry and Nathan J. Guevremont.

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